



Ubuntu 10.10

Got off on the wrong foot with Ubuntu? here's how you should have done it...

Kshitiġ Sobti

kshitiij.sobti@thinkdigit.com

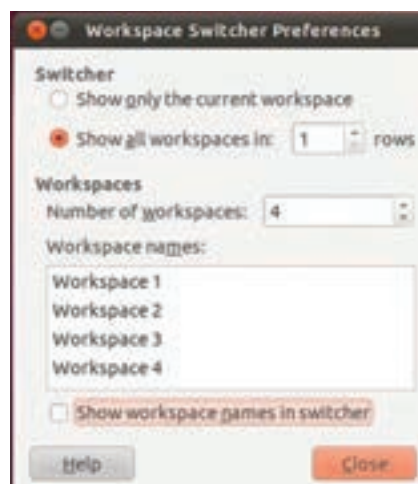
While multimedia playback and gaming might not be Linux's strong suits, sheer productivity is something it excels at. However if you thought that you had reached the peak potential just by switching to Linux, you are dead wrong! Even once you have gone Ubuntu, there are many things that you can do that will speed up your work environment even more:

5. Speed up window management

Those who switch from Windows often forget that Linux has brilliant inbuilt support for virtual desktops. Virtual desktops let you segregate the work you are doing in virtual workspaces such that there is min-

imal visual clutter. You can make segregations based on whatever suits you best.

Along with virtual desktops, you can use quick shortcuts to get to a task fast.

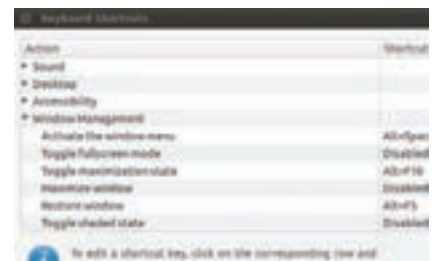


Right-click on the Virtual Desktop Pager near the bottom-right of screen and click on "Preferences". Change the number of workspaces to suit yourself

For example, moving to the next / previous virtual desktop in Ubuntu 10.10 is achieved using the [Ctrl]+[Alt]+ Right / Left keys. Additionally, you can move to the next / previous desktop taking the current windows with you by using the [Ctrl]+[Alt]+[Shift]+ Right / Left key combinations.

4. Optimise desktop effects

Visual effects are not merely eye candy, they can be a huge help in helping us



You can change shortcuts for different tasks or create a new shortcut for a custom command from here

visualise our tasks, and can help us work faster. For example, enabling the Desktop Wall effect allows you to see all your virtual desktops in one view, giving you quick overview of your active windows. This way you can quickly switch to an application on any desktop, and in this meta-desktop mode, you can move your windows around in your virtual spaces with greater ease.

While such effects do increase your productivity, others such as wobbly windows, are purely for show, with little utility whatsoever. If you do not care for such visual effects, you can turn these off if you want.

Some actions such as opening / closing, minimizing / maximizing windows, can be animated in Ubuntu. While this does give the appearance of a smoother and faster desktop, as something is always in motion, the animations themselves add precious milliseconds / seconds to your application launch times. Instead of prolonged animation durations, you can make your system both appear faster, and work faster by reducing these animation durations.

To change these settings and fully juice out your visual effects, you need to install the significantly more advanced Compiz configuration manager. It will let